Entrepreneurship

Definition

A person who makes money by starting or running a business, especially by taking financial risks.

Common Traits

Passion — they believe in themselves and in their product

Optimism — they celebrate the small wins

Resilience — they can take a hundred no's, or "we won't invest"

Introspective — they know their own weaknesses

Methodical — they set goals and track them properly

Direct — you don't get what you don't ask for

Focused — a deep understanding of one thing beats shallow knowledge of many

Resourceful — creative and frugal with whatever they have

Patient — good ideas take years, not weeks

Curious — they keep asking why until they really understand

Decisive — they make the call and move on

Honest — they admit what they don't know

Discussion

Have you heard of this term before? What does it mean to you?

How is an entrepreneur different from a business owner or a founder?

Who are the most famous entrepreneurs in China today? What about the rest of the world?

What helped them succeed — timing, talent, luck, or the people they knew?

What lessons can you learn from their stories?

Which of these traits do you already have, and which would you work on?

Would you rather start your own business or join a big company? Why?

What is the biggest risk of starting a business in your city?

What is the most recent inconvenience you ran into, and how would you fix it?

What else do you think makes a good entrepreneur?